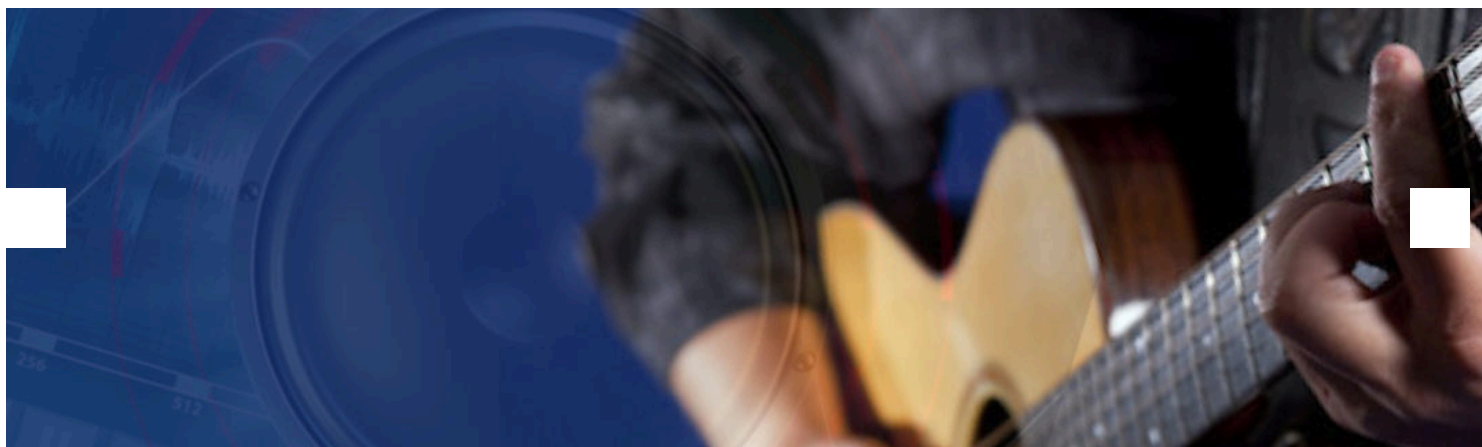




Focusing Your Lyrics: Try Writing a Short Essay

Posted on December 9, 2013 by Gary Ewer

Writing a short story on your song's topic is a great intermediate step for writing a good lyric.

Download "The Essential Secrets of Songwriting" 6 eBook Bundle, and get "From Amateur to Ace: Writing Songs Like a Pro" **free**. [Read more..](#)

[Follow Gary Ewer on Twitter](#)



One common complaint of songwriters, especially those new to the activity, is coming up with something to write about.

[Donate](#)

Get the Songwriting eBook Bundle!

Stop struggling with your songwriting technique. 10 eBooks that cover every aspect of songwriting!



Buy Now

\$37 USD (Immediate Download)

or [READ MORE](#)

Recent Posts

[What Should AI Mean to](#)

Many songs deal with the emotion of love, but that's just an upper-level category that doesn't really suggest anything interesting in and of itself.

Good lyrics need a better focus than to simply say that you're going to write about love. There needs to be something of a story, something more interesting happening to the characters of the song. Even if the song isn't so much a story as it is a situation, there needs to be a captivating focus to the song's topic and lyrics.

Many songwriters create word lists as a way of digging down into a topic, and it's a method [I've suggested](#). By creating word lists, you start to see ideas that may not have been previously apparent. Word lists don't just offer you a better source of words and phrases to use, they can allow you to hone your topic, and find an interesting angle to write about that you hadn't thought of before.

Once you've created your word lists, you might try something else before creating your lyric: **writing a short, descriptive essay**.

This only needs to be a couple of paragraphs long, certainly no longer than a couple of pages. The word lists will give you a fairly clear idea of what your song topic is going to be, but **the writing of an essay will allow the ideas to take solid form**.

Let's say that you've decided your song is going to be about your grandfather who has recently passed away. Your word lists may reveal something more specific: that time that your grandfather took you fishing for the first time, creating a lifelong memory and a love of the outdoors.

Now, before you start creating your lyric, **try writing a short story about that time**. Don't worry about writing something worth publishing – it's more important to simply get your thoughts down on paper.

"I'll never forget the excitement I felt when Granddad took me fishing. He arrived at the door early that morning, wearing that funny hat with the hooks in the band. He put his hand on my

[You as a Songwriter?](#)

[Being Prolific is Only Good If You're Writing Good Songs](#)

[Why Developing a Diverse Songwriting Style is Crucial to Building a Larger Fan Base](#)

[Using the Range of Your Melody to Create Musical Energy](#)

[Don't Ignore Your Playing When You're Concentrating On Songwriting](#)

Archives

Select Month 

Categories

Select Category 

Meta

[Log in](#)

[Entries feed](#)

[Comments feed](#)

[WordPress.org](#)

Read What Songwriters Are Saying About Gary's Songwriting Ebook Bundle:



I ordered your e-books, and I

shoulder and said, “Ready to catch some fish?” I nodded and ran to grab my fishing gear...”

An essay helps focus your thoughts, and helps you create the story. It can even give you lines that will make its way into the lyric. In your essay, describes sights and sounds – anything and everything that helps you focus on your topic.

Once you’ve created a story, read it a few times, then set it aside to begin creating your lyric. Go back to your story when you get stuck for words or ideas, or if you find yourself in need of a shot of inspiration.

By creating a short essay in this way, you help design a story without the pressure (yet) to create a lyric. It helps you focus and in a sense, puts flesh on the skeleton of ideas that you came up with in your word lists. It can serve as an important and useful step in the creation of a good song lyric.



The Essential Secrets of Songwriting 6-eBook Bundle now contains a 7th eBook – and right now, that eBook is

FREE. “*From Amateur to Ace – Writing Songs Like a Pro*” shows you the most common errors songwriters make, and how to quickly solve them. These 7 eBooks are all available at a bundle price of \$37 (reg. \$95.70). [Click here to learn more.](#)

Posted in [lyrics](#) and tagged [essay](#), [inspiration](#), [lyrics](#), [music](#), [short story](#), [songs](#), [songwriter](#), [songwriting](#).

Post

Share

am absolutely loving them. I've only very recently started writing songs (I've written four...but all within the last week!), and the information you offer is incredibly useful. So, thank you!

Sue
Los Angeles,
California,
USA



I wanted to let you know that I am completely enjoying your e-books. I think

← Your Finished Song Missing Something? Predictability in Songwriting Gets an... →

Leave a Reply

Your email address will not be published. Required fields are marked *

Comment *

Name *

Email *

Website

Post Comment

This site uses Akismet to reduce spam. [Learn how your comment data is processed.](#)

they
are
brilliant
and
fabulous
to
learn
by.
I've
written
medical
texts
before
and
the
secret
is to
not
talk
down
to
people,
make
it
understandable
and
you've
done
an
outstanding
job on
that.

Phillip
Tirman,
MD
California,
USA



As a
beginner,
I have
visited
a
number
of
sites
offering

music
lessons
and I
find
your
site
more
trainee
friendly.
The
material
presentation
is not
only
precise
but
also
specific
for
easy
grasp.
I
thought
I
should
commend
you
for the
good
work.
God
bless.

P.P.
UK



Hi
Gary, I
just
love
all of
your
e-
books.
I do
hip
hop as

well
as
other
styles
like
r&b,
neo
soul,
and
jazz. I
often
refer
to
your
e-
books
for
inspiration.
You
have
been
stellar
in my
book.
Keep
it
coming.

Francis
USA



I
recently
bought
your
collection
of e-
books
on
song
writing,
chord
changes
and
creating
harmonies
and I

would
just
like to
let you
know
how
pleased
I am
with
them.
They
have
very
clearly
answered
so
many
of the
things
about
music
writing
which
I've
never
been
able
to
really
find a
clear
answer
to
before.
My
enthusiasm
for
song
writing
has
just
come
back
with a
vengeance!
Many
thanks!

Andy
UK



The Essential Secrets of Songwriting, © 2025